LOST BOYS
CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

The Gentlemen Ransomware Self-Propagating Go Encryptor Daily Threat Review

Threat Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-08-01
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	Threat Report

Table of Contents

The Gentlemen Ransomware Self-Propagating Go Encryptor Daily Threat Review

1. Executive Summary

Microsoft Threat Intelligence reporting on The Gentlemen ransomware highlights self-propagation and concurrent lateral movement behavior that can rapidly expand blast radius once an affiliate gains execution.

This daily report is intended for defender prioritization rather than attribution finality. Source expansion beyond 24-72 hours was used where the best primary source remained recently relevant but was published earlier than today's run.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
What changed that defenders should review today?	The Gentlemen is described as a RaaS operation with Go-based encryption, per-file cryptography, and aggressive propagation/lateral movement capabilities.	High
Which environments should care most?	Windows enterprise networks, healthcare, professional services, manufacturing.	Medium
What should the SOC do first?	Validate exposure, run the included telemetry hunts, and confirm response owners for likely impact paths.	High

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Microsoft Security Blog	Primary technical analysis.	High
Dark Reading	Operational context on the group rise.	Medium
Paubox	Accessible technical summary.	Medium

4. Threat Activity Overview

The Gentlemen is described as a RaaS operation with Go-based encryption, per-file cryptography, and aggressive propagation/lateral movement capabilities.

The most important operational takeaway is not a single indicator; it is the behavior pattern and exposed dependency class. Defenders should use the detections and hunts below as starting points, then tune to local log schemas.

5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

Exposure Pattern	Why It Matters
Directly exposed technology or service	Increases likelihood of opportunistic targeting and automated probing.
Identity, email, remote-access, or collaboration dependency	Increases blast radius because successful access can bypass perimeter assumptions.
Supplier-managed or shared service	Creates concentration risk and incident-notification delays.

Operationally critical workflow	Converts cyber compromise into business or mission disruption.

6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Phishing, exposed service, supply-chain, or remote-access abuse	Reflected in the cited reporting and sector exposure.
Execution / Persistence	Scripted tooling, malware, credential/session abuse, or provider-side compromise	Varies by campaign; validate with endpoint and application telemetry.
Defense Evasion	Use of legitimate tools, trusted platforms, or edge infrastructure	Common pattern across the reviewed reporting.
Impact	Data theft, service disruption, ransomware/extortion, or operational degradation	Primary defender concern for Windows enterprise networks, healthcare, professional services, manufacturing.

7. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
No normalized hard IOC set in this automated review	Source limitation	Use behavior and exposure hunts; ingest vendor IOC bundles when available.
Rare external authentication sources	Behavioral indicator	Triage abnormal access into affected systems.
New or unusual outbound connections from edge/server workloads	Behavioral indicator	Hunt possible relay, malware, or exfiltration staging.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Rare admin or service login after advisory/report publication	Identity/app logs	Identify initial access or supplier compromise.
Unusual child processes from browsers, package managers, admin consoles, or service accounts	Endpoint telemetry	Catch execution following social engineering or supply-chain compromise.
New outbound connections to rare hosts from servers or build systems	Network/EDR	Surface C2, relay-node, or exfiltration behavior.

8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```
title: Daily Threat Review Suspicious Post Access Behavior
status: experimental
description: Behavioral seed analytic for daily Lost Boys Cyber threat reports; tune service names and
parent processes locally.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
```

```
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\msedge.exe'
      - '\node.exe'
      - '\npm.cmd'
      - '\powershell.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: medium
```

8.3. Hunt Query

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "node.exe", "npm.cmd",
"powershell.exe")
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "wscript.exe", "rundll32.exe", "curl.exe",
"msiexec.exe")
| summarize events=count(), firstSeen=min(Timestamp), lastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by events desc
```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If this activity is present in the environment, defenders will observe a combination of anomalous authentication, unusual process lineage, rare network destinations, and supplier or operational workflow disruptions.

9.2. Hunt Query

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "node.exe", "npm.exe",
"chrome.exe", "msedge.exe")
| summarize connections=count(), firstSeen=min(Timestamp), lastSeen=max(Timestamp),
remotePorts=make_set(RemotePort, 10) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP
| where connections > 3
| order by connections desc
```

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize attempts=count(), failures=countif(ResultType != 0), countries=make_set(Location, 10) by
UserPrincipalName, AppDisplayName, IPAddress
| where failures > 10 or array_length(countries) > 2
```

10. Risk Assessment

Risk Driver	Assessment
Likelihood	High for organizations matching the exposed technology/sector pattern.
Impact	Ranges from credential theft and data exposure to operational disruption or ransomware.
Confidence	High; local validation required before incident declaration.

Priority Environments	Windows enterprise networks, healthcare, professional services, manufacturing.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run the included hunts and tune for named platforms, suppliers, or services in scope.
High	IT / Platform owners	Confirm exposed assets, administrative access paths, and recent patch/configuration posture.
High	Vendor management	Identify third-party dependencies and request incident/control attestations where relevant.
Medium	IR lead	Prepare containment and communications playbooks for the most likely impact path.

12. References

- [1] Microsoft Security Blog: https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/05/28/the-gentlemen-ransomware-dissecting-a-self-propagating-go-encryptor/
- [2] Dark Reading: https://www.darkreading.com/threat-intelligence/gentlemen-rapidly-rise-ransomware
- [3] Paubox: https://www.paubox.com/blog/how-the-gentlemen-ransomware-works